

cards, student loans, and other account information, hasn't been adequately cleaned or destroyed, a fraudster will go dumpster diving.

Quid Pro Quo

When a criminal requests the exchange of sensitive information like as important data, login credentials, or monetary worth in exchange for a service, this is known as quid pro quo. For example, a computer user might get a call from a criminal posing as a technology expert offering free IT help or technological upgrades in exchange for login information. If an offer appears to be too good to be true, it is most certainly a hoax.

Example of a social engineering attack

Almost every hack includes some type of social engineering. Most social engineering techniques also include malware, which is harmful software that silently wreaks havoc on our computers while potentially spying on us.

Phishing

Phishing is a common technique for obtaining information from an unknowing victim. This is how it usually works: A cybercriminal, often known as a phisher, sends a message to a target asking for information or action that could aid in the commission of a more serious crime. The request could be as easy as asking you to download a file or double-checking your address. It's worth mentioning that social engineers can use a variety of phishing techniques, each with its own set of targets.

Spam phishing frequently takes the shape of a large-scale email campaign that does not necessarily target a particular person. Spear phishing is a type of phishing that targets specific users by impersonating a trusted contact. Celebrities and high-ranking businesspeople are the targets of whaling.

Phishing can be done in a variety of ways:

- **Vishing** - When your phone call is recorded, including information entered on PIN pads, it is known as vishing or voice phishing.
- **Smishing** - Or SMS phishing, refers to texts that include malicious links.
- **Email phishing** - It is one of the most common phishing methods, which involves sending a malicious link or a download over email.
- **Angler phishing** - When a cybercriminal impersonates a customer service representative to intercept your communications and private messages, this is known as angler phishing.
- **URL phishing** - When you receive a forged link that contains malware.